LONGEVITY 16

Resveratrol

Plant compound (3,5,4'-trihydroxystilbene) found in grapes, red wine, some berries and roots



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Plant compound (dietary supplement)	Metabolism, Alzheimer's, aging	Controlled human trials	Dietary supplement · not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

- **Insulin, metabolism** — HUMAN
- **Alzheimer's disease** — HUMAN
- **Survival** — HUMAN
- **Lifespan** — ANIMAL

Results disagree. One 30-day study in 11 obese men found calorie-restriction-like changes; larger, longer trials in women and obese men found none.

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Many small randomized trials; results mixed
- Phase 2 Alzheimer's trial, 119 people
- Some animal heart papers retracted

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Effect on aging in people
- Meaning of brain volume loss

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Resveratrol → SIRT1 and AMPK → Fasting pathways → Metabolism

- **Proposed to act on sirtuins (SIRT1) and AMPK,** linked to calorie restriction
- **Extended lifespan** in yeast, worms and flies; in mice only on a high-calorie diet
- **A 2012 trial in women** found no change in SIRT1 or AMPK in muscle or fat
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	By mouth
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Reached the brain in an Alzheimer's trial; limited human data	Dietary supplement; 503A Category 1 for compounding
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Insulin sensitivity, blood fats, brain MRI, amyloid	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

- FDA — Not approved as a drug
- FDA — 503A Category 1 (under evaluation)
- FDA — GRAS notice GRN 224 stopped at notifier's request
- WADA — Not listed

REFERENCES

1. Neurology, randomized trial of resveratrol in Alzheimer's disease, Oct 2015
2. Cell Metab, resveratrol in non-obese women with normal glucose, Nov 2012
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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